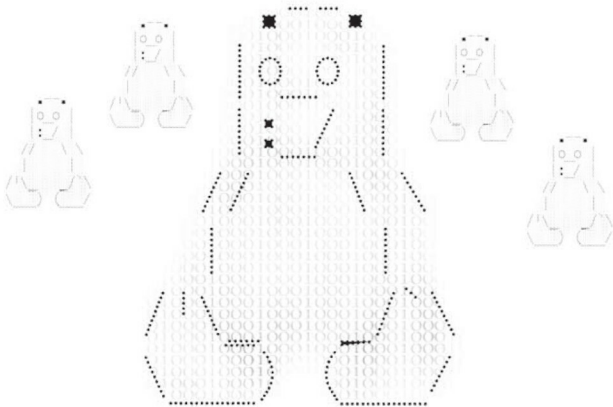




# Programming Tools for Linux

This article is not so much about the various languages, as the programming tools that can be used to write programs using the languages.

When students first start taking programming courses at various private classes and colleges, the first language they learn is C. This is because C is the most traditional language, whose concepts form the base of every other language. The scenario is changing, with people having discovered the power of Python over other languages. Python has become the first language to be learned, because it has a very user-friendly syntax.

## Outdated IDEs

Often, in colleges and programming classes, while teaching C/C++, instructors do so in Turbo C/C++ or Borland C/C++ on Windows XP. When one asks them about various other IDEs (integrated development

environments), the response is that we must use Turbo C/C++ or Borland C/C++. This is especially true in colleges, where teachers wield more authority over students, who are 'forced' to program in the IDEs mentioned above. These IDEs had their last release somewhere in 1994-95, and we are living in 2012; it makes absolutely no sense, and it's absurd to use a program that is 18 years old! Even the standards of C and C++ have been revised more than once to include better features, etc, since their release.

For example, here is an error I have encountered quite often while programming in Borland at college. In a C function, you declare variables at the beginning of the function. Then you write some code, and after that, you find you need another